If You Wake Her Up, I Will Bite You

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/61374940.

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

It's been about one week since Horde Prime and everything that happened at the Heart. Feeling the responsibilities and the call of duty, Adora hasn't had a spare moment to really recover from that day. Unfortunately, the exhaustion from everything is still lingering. She knows that eventually she'll need to stop and rest. She does know that. Unfortunately, though, Etheria still needs their hero. At least that's what Adora believes, so she can't rest. Not yet anyway.

Fortunately (or perhaps unfortunately) Catra has noticed Adora's exhaustion as well...

Notes

Alright, another post-canon SPOP fic! I actually enjoyed writing "The Jacket", which if you haven't checked it out, I recommend doing so! It doesn't really connect to this fic but it is a nice, fluff piece with Adora being a dork so there's that! Anyway, this is two parts! The first part is in Adora's POV and the second will be in Catra's. I'm hoping to have Catra's chapter written and maybe posted tomorrow... Maybe. Just in case though, I would recommend subscribing or bookmarking this fic if you're interested in Catra's chapter!

Also, there was no beta-reader for this fic and it is currently after 2am so I apologize for any errors!

I didn't do as much writing as I wanted to do today and I have a couple of other projects that I want to work on tomorrow as well.

This is fic was inspired by "you make me feel like I am home again" by Ecrooked24, "When the Smoke and Dust Settle" by

CompletelyDifferent, and lastly "After Prime" by aprilserein.

The first two fics mentioned are completed and one-shots (well, technically "When the Smoke and Dust Settle" has two chapters) and "After Prime" is incomplete as of right now but it is a good fic and I recommend all three to anyone who enjoys SPOP fics!

See the end of the work for more notes

Adora

"Okay, so after we meet with Perfuma, we need to head over to Salinas and check up on their progress. Mermista said that– Adora! Are you listening?"

Adora stopped mid yawn. Glimmer had stopped and was now glaring at her. Adora gave a sheepish smile. They had been walking through Bright Moon's halls, discussing the schedule that had somehow gotten busier despite the war being over. It was still morning. It wasn't *early* in the morning, but for some reason, Adora still felt tired… Actually, she felt exhausted. And she had for a *while* now.

"Sorry!" Adora replied, giving a sheepish smile. She rubbed the back of her head, a nervous tic she developed over the years. She didn't even realize it until Catra pointed it out a couple of days ago. She caught herself and immediately stopped, her arm shooting back down to her side.

Glimmer studied for her for a moment. She was watching her so intensely now it made Adora want to squirm. After a bit, Glimmer's gaze softened.

"Are you sure you're okay?" Glimmer finally asked. There was a faint hint of concern in her tone as she asked, her eyes shone with worry now. It resembled the look that Catra had given Adora this morning when she finally got out of bed.

"Yeah. Of course!" she replied hastily. She didn't feel fine. She felt like climbing back into bed, tunneling under the covers and sleeping for the next few weeks, maybe even the next few months. Why was she *so* exhausted? It had been a week since the Heart. She had gotten plenty of rest since then, right?

"Why wouldn't I be?" Adora asked, trying to sound as normal as possible. Glimmer's gaze lingered on her for a bit longer. It was making her nervous now, like she had done something wrong. All

she did was yawn… Seriously, why was Glimmer watching her so closely? After a moment, Glimmer sighed. She closed her eyes and rubbed her temple.

"A-are you okay, Glimmer?" Adora finally asked, uncertain. The sudden silence was making her antsy.

"Yes, Adora, I'm fine," Glimmer huffed, though she could detect the irritation in her voice. She finally stopped rubbing her temple and opened her eyes. Her gaze met Adora's.

"I think Catra was right," said Glimmer suddenly.

Adora raised an eyebrow. Catra was right? About what? She opened her mouth to ask Glimmer to elaborate but before she could ask, Glimmer continued, "You need a break."

A *break*?! She didn't need a break. Not yet at least. She needed to make sure that Etheria was okay. She needed to help out the Princess Alliance. She needed to keep training, to be strong enough to face the next threat. She *also* needed to check in with Entrapa about Darla for their next space adventure… Not that she told the rest of the Best Friend Squad about that… Not even Catra. Not yet anyway. They knew that eventually she wanted to go on another "Best Friend Road Trip". They probably just didn't know *where* she was actually wanting to go. The world that she wanted– *No*, *needed* to find–

Before she could say anything, Glimmer spoke again, "Listen, just…"

She stopped suddenly. There was a new look in her eyes now. One that Adora hadn't seen since the "Portal Incident". Glimmer grabbed her shoulder and–

Poof!

There was a shriek. And then–

"Seriously, Sparkles?! No warning?"

They were back in her bedroom. Catra was now standing on the windowseat, her ears pinned back and her tail puffed up. Their sudden appearance had startled Melog too. They were standing beside Catra, mane glowing and red.

Adora's eyes met Catra's and she saw the anger immediately disappear from the magicat's face, replaced now with worry. Melog glanced at Catra, their posture relaxing finally, but their mane was still red… Not a great sign…

"Yeah," Adora began quickly, trying to quell Catra's concern, "I–"

Glimmer held a hand up, blocking Adora's view of Catra and cutting her off.

"Yeah, Catra, you were *right*," she huffed irritably.

Adora huffed in annoyance. Seriously, when were they talking about her? And *why* behind her back? She needed to know what was going on. She sighed, trying to tamper her aggravation at it all. She opened her mouth but before she could ask just *what was going on* and *why are you all talking about* me *behind my back*, Catra suddenly shouted in frustration, "See! I told you!"

"Okay," Adora sighed. She really needed to figure out *what* was going on. She lowered Glimmer's still raised hand down from her face. Adora groaned and continued, "Can someone please–"

"Listen! I know, I just…" Glimmer's words faded out, she rubbed her temple again. Adora glanced between her and Catra. The magicat now had a smug grin on her face. Melog's mane finally returned to its normal blue. When did that happen?

"You were right," Glimmer repeated with a groan. She glanced at Adora for a moment, her face softening and then back at Catra. She then added, "Just make sure she actually *rests*. Please! Not that I that I *have* to tell you that but…"

She went quiet again. Catra leapt off the window seat and made her way towards them. The smirk was gone now, replaced by a

small, concerned smile.

"I know, Sparkles," she said gently. She took Adora's hand in hers. Glimmer glanced at Adora now, gave her a small smile and then teleported out of the room.

"Okay," Adora began, her irritation growing suddenly. Why were they talking about *her*? Specifically, why were they talking about her behind her back?

"Catra, what is going–"

Catra put a finger to her lips, immediately silencing her. She quietly shushed her as well and began to lead her towards the bed. With one hand, Catra pulled the comforter back and ushered her to sit down on the mattress, which she instantly sank into. The old, hard mattress had been replaced a couple of days ago. Now it was just like the other beds in Bright Moon. It was too plush, too soft.

Melog jumped down from the window seat and made their way to the bed. They leapt up onto the bed went to Adora's side, nudging her with their head.

"Hey, Melog," Adora whispered as she pet their head. The rumble of their purr now filled the room. Seemingly satisfied with Melog keeping her on the bed now, Catra turned and walked over to the dresser.

"Catra, what are you…?" She let her words trail off. She figured that if Catra was going to answer, she would have already. But she didn't and so Adora let silence fall between them. At least it would have been silent, if it wasn't for Melog's purring, which was gradually growing *louder* with each passing second, it seemed. It was strangely relaxing. She paused her petting of Melog, bringing a hand to face to try and stifle a yawn that threatened to break free. It didn't work.

"Here," came Catra's gentle voice and suddenly a pair of pajamas were being held in her line of sight.

"Catra, what?" she yawned again. The exhaustion that had lingered since she woke up was increasing. Her eyelids felt heavy.

"Just put these on," Catra sighed, rolling her eyes for some reason.

Adora took the new clothes from her, though the puzzled expression didn't leave her face. Catra then held a hand out. Adora stared at it. She wasn't sure what she was supposed to–

"It's gonna be pretty hard to change when you're *literally* sinking into the mattress, dummy," she chided gently.

Oh. She took Catra's hand and was immediately pulled to her feet. Catra gave her another soft smile.

"I'm gonna go grab something. Be right back.

With her hand on the doorknob, she looked back over her shoulder at Adora and added, "Don't go anywhere. Okay?"

"Yeah… Okay," Adora mumbled in reply, watching confusedly as Catra hurried out of the room. That was… weird… Right? She glanced down at the pajamas in her hands and then quickly changed. She then sat back down on the bed and waited. She wasn't sure how long she waited. It felt like hours. It felt like minutes. Time was moving… *weirdly* now.

At some point, she fell onto her back and sunk into the mattress again. She stared up blankly at the high ceiling… Why were the ceilings so high in Bright Moon? She was vaguely aware of Melog coming and curling up by her side, their loud purr thundering. Seriously, why were purrs so relaxing? Why did that sound always seem to lull her to sleep…

Her eyes gradually began to shut. It was strangely quiet in Bright Moon all of a sudden. She didn't hear the usual heavy, metal footsteps of the hourly patrols. She didn't hear the voices of the guards as they walked by. The rumble of Melog's purr was the

only sound that filled her room, maybe even the hallway, it was *really* loud.

She focused on Melog's purring. Maybe it would help her stay awake– Her mind drifted. Sleep was coming. It was coming strongly, she became aware. Her eyes shot back open. She needed to wait for Catra… Right? Catra asked her to wait. She said… What did she say again? She was so tired that she didn't even hear the sound of the bedroom door opening and closing, or Catra's faint footsteps as she returned to the bed.

"Hey, drink this."

A hand was on her shoulder now. She felt it. She didn't see anyone– Oh! She opened her eyes wearily, Catra was standing over her, a small mug in her other hand. She took a step back, removing her hand from Adora's shoulder and held it out to help back into a sitting position. As soon as she was sitting upright again, she handed Adora the mug and as soon as Adora took it, she reached back and undid the ponytail.

Adora glanced at the liquid in the cup, it was a light purple color and it smelled like… lavender? Wait a second… Was this…?

"Catra–"

"Just drink it," Catra replied softly. Adora looked up at her. There was a small smile on her face but her brow was furrowed and despite the gentleness in her gaze, Adora could see traces of concern as well. She glanced back down at the mug and sighed. She hated to see or even make Catra worry. If drinking this tea helped to ease *whatever* was concerning Catra, then she would do it.

As soon as she finished, she handed Catra the empty mug. She couldn't stop the yawn that came next. Her eyelids were really feeling heavy now… They were already but now they felt even *heavier* somehow…

She lied back down, her eyes gradually (or maybe quickly…? Time was moving so strangely) closing. She heard a familiar sound… It wasn't Melog's purring though. There was a new voice now and Catra was talking to *someone*...? She could barely make out the conversation. Their voices filtering in and out, they were hazy and faint…

"...Finally…"

"...Can't believe…A whole week…"

She finally recognized the other voice. It was Glimmer. What was Glimmer doing back? There was another voice now. A third one, she realized. It sounded masculine… Probably Bow… Why though…? She couldn't catch of Bow's words. She was certain that she was hearing his voice though, if only faintly.

The voices faded out. Adora's mind gradually quieted itself. Suddenly, Melog's purring grew louder.

Catra

Chapter Summary

> Over the last few days, Catra has kept a close eye on Adora. Noticing that the events of the Heart and maybe even the war has worn Adora out, she begins to plot the best course of action to protect her blonde idiot from herself.

Chapter Notes

> Thank you to Lyssandia for beta-reading this chapter! I really appreciate it! You are the best!
>
> This chapter is set in Catra's POV! I have two more chapters for this fic, I am not sure when I will write and post them, so if you enjoy this particular fic, I recommend subscribing or bookmarking it!
>
> Now, it is after midnight here and I am pretty exhausted myself, so if there are any errors I missed during my edits, I apologize! I wanted to get this out tonight (or today...?) though.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra huffed in annoyance. Her tail thumped against the side of the window seat. One of the pillows from the bed was behind her, allowing her to sit up comfortably on the window seat with the early morning day-moon shining through the open window. The weather was nice; it wasn't too hot, it wasn't too cold either. It was *perfect*. A spring breeze drifted in, causing the curtains to sway gently.

Melog was curled up by her feet, in a sleep so deep that they snored lightly. They seemed relaxed, apparently enough that they didn't even notice her damping mood. It shouldn't irritate her but it did. She glanced at their sleeping form, peaceful and somehow completely unaware of the battle going on inside her head. Any

other time, Melog would be awake and checking up on her; not today though… And that frustrated her a bit.

Her book was on the windowsill, forgotten now after she spent too much time rereading the same sentence over and over again. She was staring up at the *ridiculously* tall ceiling of the bedroom now. Seriously, why was Bright Moon built like this? She understood that it was a castle, she understood that it was supposed to be this *grand* palace or whatever, still *this*... The high ceilings, the multiple floors (she still wasn't sure how many floors or sets of stairs this castle had), and the waterfall... It was all too much, way too much.

That wasn't what was causing her irritation though, at least not today. No. Her frustration had been building for a few days now, probably the second day after the Heart.

It had only been a week, give or take, since the Heart. A week since the fall of Horde Prime. And to her ever growing frustration… Adora still hadn't taken the time to recover.

Sure. Adora *seemed* fine immediately after the Heart. She *somehow* managed to channel all of that magic and now the Fright Zone wasn't a wasteland anymore. She wasn't fighting, so that was one less thing for Catra to be stressed about. Most of Adora's time was spent attending meetings with Glimmer. The two of them spent the day after the Heart meeting with the other princesses and coming up with a plan for the aftermath.

After that, the two of them would teleport all across Etheria, trying to help anyone who needed it. Her and Bow had accompanied them a couple of times, but for the most part, it was just the two of them, trying to do their duties as She-Ra and the Queen of Bright Moon. Both her and Bow spent a couple of days trying to convince them to rest, to take at least a day. Of course their pleads fell on deaf ears, and Bow had to draw Catra off before she went off on *both* of them.

Exhaustion wasn't the only concern that Catra had when it came to Adora. She still had her lingering worry about the cut. The cut *seemed* okay… Adora said it was okay, she tried to convince her that it completely scabbed over and healed after she turned into She-Ra. Still though, Catra wasn't convinced. She wanted to check on it herself. She got a few glimpses of it here and there since the days following the Heart but it wasn't a close look.

She was worried. Adora was so, so close to death that day. Adora probably could've died at the Heart. She got wounded. She got poisoned. She took on *almost* all of Etheria's locked-up magic… Despite all of that though, she still hasn't slowed down. Adora barely got eight hours of sleep a night; oftentimes she would wake up well before everyone else and still go outside to train, even though there wasn't a threat anymore.

Any normal person would have stopped. Any *normal* person would have taken a day or two, or even a week to rest and relax after everything that they went through… But once again, Catra had to resign herself to the ever lingering concern that Adora wasn't normal. And that wasn't *just* because she was She-Ra. She had spent years in the Fright Zone fighting Adora, arguing with her that she needed rest just as much as anyone else. Although Adora had changed during her time in the Rebellion, apparently the self-sacrificing stuff was still there; it was still a big part of her, and that scared Catra.

After days of going non-stop, the exhaustion from the Heart was now visible. Catra noticed the ever increasing darkening bags under Adora's eyes. The bags were especially present this morning, and the last couple of mornings now.

She watched carefully whenever Adora would take too long to get out of bed. Getting up this morning looked as though it took quite a bit out of Adora the last couple of days now. For a moment, she had hoped that the blonde would just give up. Give up and crawl back under the covers and finally rest, finally sleep. Maybe for a few days, maybe for the next week... Unfortunately, that wasn't

the case. It never was, to Catra's ever growing frustration and concern.

She cornered Glimmer a little bit after breakfast. She managed to catch Bright Moon's queen alone and explain to her everything she had been noticing about Adora's current state. The stiff movements. The eyebags. The struggle to get out of bed. The general exhaustion.

Sparkles let her talk. In fact, she let Catra voice all of her current annoyances about Adora and her inability to just take a moment to take care of herself and rest. At the end of her rant, Glimmer sighed and confided in her as well.

"Yeah… I've been noticing all that stuff as well…"

Catra crossed her arms, scowling. Her tail flickering wildly behind her. Her ears weren't pinned back; not yet at least, but if Glimmer didn't agree with her… then they might.

"So…" Catra let the question hang in the air. She knew that Sparkles understood; the unsaid request. As Bright Moon's queen and leader of the Rebellion, or the Princess Alliance, or whatever they called themselves, Glimmer had the power to order Adora to stay at the castle. Whatever she said, Adora would *have* to obey it. Even if it was something as stupid as just staying in bed for a few days and spending the time resting and recovering.

Glimmer sighed again and pinched the bridge of her nose. She closed her eyes and didn't even bother to open them when she finally replied exasperatedly, "Listen, Catra…" She stopped, as if she was carefully considering her word choice now. She opened her eyes again but she didn't dare to meet Catra's hardened gaze.

"You… We can't just make Adora stay here and rest. It doesn't work like that. Any time–"

"You're literally the queen," Catra shot back, the frustration building in her voice, "She has to listen to you."

Glimmer finally glanced in her direction. There was a small, soft, understanding smile on her face. She reached out and put a hand on Catra's shoulder. The gesture made Catra's scowl deepen, so Glimmer hurriedly removed her hand.

"Listen," Glimmer began gently, "Adora will tell us when she needs a break."

Catra wanted to scoff at that. She almost busted out laughing in Sparkles' face. *Seriously*... How long had Glimmer known Adora now? Adora was with the Rebellion for *how long* without her? How did she even survive? Just *who* was watching her back for the last few years? It wasn't Sparkles apparently. Maybe it was Arrow-Boy? Yeah. That would make sense. Bow seemed way more like the kind of person to look out for his friends.

"How about this," Glimmer began, the soft smile still on her face, "If… And only *if*," she repeated the word for emphasis, "Adora seems too tired for today's missions… I'll bench her."

Catra opened her mouth to reply but was cut off by Sparkle's continued rambling, "I'll teleport her immediately to her room and then *you*--" And here, she made direct eye-contact with Catra now. "*You* can make her rest."

Alright. A compromise. She could work with that. Hopefully.

"So, *you're* going to decide if Adora seems too tired?" Catra asked. Despite her arms still being crossed, she pointed at Sparkles, as if to emphasize.

"Correct."

She opened her mouth again, to ask another question. To demand how Sparkles could *possibly* know what a "too tired" Adora looked like. Before she could though, Glimmer held a hand up and continued once more, "I've been her friend for a few years now, Catra. I *know* what it looks like when she's exhausted."

Catra's eyes narrowed and she bit back the old jealousy that threatened to rise up. Sure. Adora and Glimmer may be friends, maybe they're even *best friends* now. Sure, they've been *close* friends for the last few years now, but Adora was her friend first. And Adora was her friend for a longer time. They grew up together. Even a war couldn't fully sever their bond. Catra huffed in annoyance.

"Fine then…" She grumbled, glancing away from Glimmer now to hide her frustration. Her tail still twitched, and she was dimly aware that her ears were slightly pinned back now. She sighed and tried to relax herself a bit. Her ears went back up, but her tail still moved like it had a mind of its own.

"I'll trust you on this, Sparkles," she muttered. Her gaze flickered back to Glimmer once more and she added a little harshly, "But if she collapses or something–"

"She'll be okay, Catra," Glimmer whined, now looking utterly exasperated with the magicat.

Catra still wasn't convinced though. She crossed her arms and glanced away from Glimmer, her irritation was reaching a boiling point now. She wanted to scowl. A part of her knew she was being a little frustrating. Glimmer told her that she would keep an eye on Adora. She knew that she *should* trust Glimmer.. But it was hard for her to let go. It was especially hard when she had already seen Adora at some of her lowest moments.

She'd watched Adora collapse from exhaustion at the Horde. She watched from afar when, after some scuffles while they were on separate sides, Adora would nearly collapse from spending too much time as She-Ra, and she watched as Adora pushed herself too hard while they fought together once more, against Horde Prime.

Glimmer seemed to notice her dimming mood. She groaned and then added, "Look, I have to attend a quick meeting with General Juilet and then I'm going to meet up with Adora like right after. I

promise," her gaze became intense now and she made sure to emphasize the word 'promise', "if she looks too tired, I'll send her right back to you."

"You promise?" Catra asked, seriously.

"I promise," Glimmer repeated, holding a hand up for some reason. Catra frowned at her in confusion. Why did she hold up her– Whatever. A promise was a promise. Hopefully that word meant something to Glimmer. It meant something to her and Adora. It always would.

It had roughly been an hour or so since that conversation. To stop herself from trying to prevent Adora from going on any missions today and keep herself busy, Catra decided to try and enjoy the day in the comforts of their shared room. She thought that reading might help her to keep her mind off of everything… It didn't. So now she was just angrily staring up at the ceiling, trying to convince herself that Glimmer could handle Adora. That Glimmer would be observant enough to see the usual "Adora signs" that she was too tired. Before her thoughts could spiral too much, there was a sudden and familiar sound.

Poof!

She shot up immediately and screamed. Her fur stood on its ends, her tail was straight and puffed up. Melog even startled, and instantly they were now standing beside her, their mane glowing red; she wasn't sure if it was because of her or the intruder though. She quickly scanned the room for the source of the sound, her mismatched gaze fell upon Glimmer and her anger rose again.

"Seriously, Sparkles?! No warning?" she demanded. She then realized that Glimmer wasn't by herself. She met Adora's gaze, and her anger began to fade away immediately. Adora looked confused at suddenly being in her room again. The anger was gone, but somehow it seemed as though Adora looked even *more*

tired than before. How had that happened? There was no way Glimmer had taken her out of Bright Moon yet.

She was vaguely aware of Melog looking at her. Her focus was solely on Adora, who was now trying to speak, "Yeah… I–" Glimmer held a hand up, blocking Adora's face from Catra's gaze now. She wanted to scowl about that but didn't.

"Yeah, Catra, you were right," Glimmer admitted, looking defeated and sounding a bit irritated at having to say those words. She heard Adora huff in annoyance behind Glimmer's hand.

Catra, you were right. The words echoed in her head. So, Glimmer noticed it too. She wasn't crazy then. Adora was exhausted. Adora needed rest and she needed to recover. So Glimmer kept her promise. That was good. She should thank her. She *should* do that... Instead she heard herself say this: "See! I *told* you!"

"Okay… Can someone please–"

"Listen!" Glimmer groaned, and Catra smirked. Finally, someone else would feel the same irritation that she had been feeling for the last few days. Glimmer continued, "I know! I just…" She then sighed and continued on, "You were right. Just make sure that she actually rests. Please! Not that I *have* to tell you that but…" Glimmer's frustrated expression faltered a bit. Her brows scrunched with worry, a worry that Catra was all too familiar with, at least when it came to a certain blonde idiot.

Catra leapt off the window seat, the smug smirk disappeared, a small, concerned smile meant to ease Glimmer replacing it. "I know, Sparkles," she said gently. She moved past Glimmer and took Adora's hand in hers. Glimmer glanced once more at Adora, gave her a soft smile and then–

Poof!

Glimmer was gone. It was just her, Adora, and Melog in the room now.

"Okay," Adora huffed irritatedly, "Catra, what is going–"

She put a finger to Adora's lips, which quieted her immediately. For good measure, she added a shush and then, leading by the hand, ushered her to the bed. With her free hand, she pulled the comforter back and then practically pushed Adora onto the mattress.

She stifled a laugh as Adora immediately sank into it. They replaced the mattress a couple of days ago after Catra had found out how *soft* most of the beds in Bright Moon were. Adora was crazy to have it switched out for the hard mattress in the first place. She was convinced of it. Melog jumped onto the bed and immediately made their way to Adora's side. Good. They understood the assignment then. Catra was worried about how she would convince Adora to stay in the bed while she left to get Adora's pajamas. She could hear Adora calling her, asking her what was doing. She also could hear Melog's loud purring, which seemed to be growing *louder* by the second.

She pulled a drawer open and took out the first pair of pajamas she could find.

She heard Adora yawn loudly back on the bed. Alright. It should be easy enough to convince Adora to go to sleep. Staying asleep may be a challenge though… Unless… She remembered when she first joined the Best Friend Squad, when she would have nightmares for days on end. Adora had helped her through most of them but on the rare occasions where Adora just slept through them or wasn't around, she found that she could also turn to Bow.

On Darla, Bow had trouble sleeping. One night, while walking around Darla and trying to clear and quiet her mind, she stumbled across him in the kitchen, making some kind of special tea. It worked. She was able to go back to sleep and stay asleep that night. It soon became a habit of hers, one that Adora either didn't notice or just didn't say anything about. Lavender tea. She could go to the kitchen, make some for Adora, and bring it back to the

room. That *should* help her stay asleep. It should quiet her mind enough to let her finally rest and relax.

She went back to the bed and handed Adora the fresh pair of pajamas. "Here," she offered.

Adora looked up at her tiredly. "Catra, what?" She asked with a yawn. Yeah. She desperately needed some sleep.

"Just put these on," she ordered gently. She rolled her eyes. Seriously, was Adora really planning on pushing herself until she literally collapsed from exhaustion? She seemed to be pretty close to it today.

Adora took the clothes from her. It was then that it occurred to Catra just how hard it would be for her change while she was *literally* sinking into the mattress. She really should have thought this through. Maybe Adora wasn't the only one who needed rest. She thrusted a hand out, offering it to Adora to help pull her out of the mattress that seemed to collapse over her.

Adora stared at her outreached hand awkwardly. The confusion on her face was obvious. Catra wanted to snicker from seeing the dumb look on Adora's face but instead she just chided gently, "It's going to be pretty hard to change when you're literally sinking into the mattress, dummy."

Adora's face went red and she immediately clasped Catra's offered hand. She pulled Adora up and off of the bed. Alright. While Adora got changed, she could go and make that tea. Adora seemed to be fine standing on her own, though somehow her features managed to look even more exhausted now than they did when Glimmer first brought her back.

"I'm going to go grab something," she said, "Be right back." She went to the door, her hand immediately grabbed the doorknob and she lingered. A thought occurred to her, and she glanced over her shoulder at Adora. She was still standing and she was holding

the two folded pieces of clothes in her hands. “Don’t go anywhere… Okay?” She added.

“Yeah… Okay,” Adora mumbled in reply, sounding both confused and sleepy. Catra then left the room. The halls were empty. With the Horde and Prime gone, and any semblance of threats or war completely obliviated, Glimmer opted to let most of the guards take a well-earned vacation. There were still *some* soldiers who patrolled the castle, some who still stood guard outside of the castle walls, but with the threat level diminished, Glimmer hadn’t really seen a reason to have so many at the palace right now.

“You know, *you* need to rest too…”

Catra’s ears flickered as she heard a very faint and distinct voice around the corner. Someone else groaned, loud and frustrated.

“I can rest next week. I’m fiiine…”

Another voice. Familiar. Good. Now Catra didn’t need to walk all the way to the kitchen. Catra turned the corner.

“Look, Glimmer, if Adora *finally* had to stop, then you should too. Both of you have been working non-stop since the war ended and–” Bow stopped, immediately seeing Catra as she turned the corner.

“Catra! Hey!” Bow called, waving her over. Catra closed the distance between them and her. She threw a quick glance at Glimmer. Bow was right. Sparkles did look pretty tired. She didn’t look as worn down and exhausted as Adora. She should have noticed it earlier. She had been so concerned about Adora though that everyone else had ceased to exist in her mind.

Hey, can you please tell Glimmer that she needs to rest as well?” Bow pleaded, his voice a mix of desperation and annoyance. It was a tone Catra knew quite well, one that she was too familiar with.

Catra stopped. She stood just a couple of steps away from them and crossed her arms. She watched as Glimmer glanced between her and Bow. She was starting to scowl. Catra bit back a laugh. For a brief moment, it reminded her of Adora. Her gaze then flickered toward Bow. He wasn't scowling like Glimmer, but he still looked *mildly* annoyed at least. Was this what her and Adora looked like? One of them constantly worried about the other? And the other overly frustrated with the concern?

She glanced once more at Glimmer, taking a moment to study Sparkles closer… She really should have noticed it earlier. Glimmer looked utterly *exhausted*. Maybe her exhaustion wasn't as bad as Adora's. She actually looked a *little* more rested than Adora… But it was only just. Sparkles hadn't gone through the same stuff Adora did that day, or even what Catra herself had gone through.

The cut on leg, long healed now and barely scarred, began to throb as the memory played out. Her tail twitched. It flickered down and began to curl itself around her leg… Around where the cut was… She stopped herself when she realized what she was doing, her tail hurriedly moving back up.

No… Glimmer didn't go through what her and Adora did that day. She didn't deal with that First Ones' guardian or whatever it was. She didn't have all of Etheria's magic surge through her like Adora had… Still, it was pretty clear that the final battle wore her out. The four of them hadn't really talked about what they *all* went through that day. On the occasions when it was just the four of them, no one seemed particularly eager to rehash that day. Maybe they should though.

Catra quickly glanced at Bow. His eyes met hers, pleading and he mouthed the word 'please'. His gaze shifted to Glimmer and then back at Catra, as if he was worried that she didn't understand just what he was pleading about. Catra sighed and then looked at Glimmer once more.

"Yeah… Arrow Boy is right, Sparkles. You need to rest too," she replied. Bow gave a small smile and nodded in agreement. Catra

sighed. She still had *something to ask before Glimmer left to rest. She had a favor. It was a small one but still…*

She felt guilty. She felt guilty about a lot of things right now; guilty for not noticing Glimmer's exhaustion earlier. She also felt guilty about what she was going to ask now… but it really would save her some time and who knows… Maybe it would help Sparkles. Sparkles and Adora were a lot alike; it was something she began to notice shortly after she officially joined the Best Friend Squad.

There was no harm in asking, she tried to tell herself. There were benefits for everyone. Glimmer would feel useful and maybe have some herself and sleep better and longer. She then ventured to ask, "Before you rest though–"

"I didn't agree to rest yet," Glimmer sighed, her frustration still evident. Catra couldn't stop the smirk this time. Yeah. She could see why Sparkles and Adora were friends and their bond was definitely different from the one she shared with Adora.

"Before you rest though," Catra repeated, ignoring Glimmer's interruption, "I have a favor to ask…" She let her words trail off. Glimmer perked up, looking interested now. Bow was watching them before abrasively. Catra tried to offer him a quick, small smile. Hopefully Bow would see the benefit of this request.

"I need to go to the kitchen to make some tea," she continued, "And I really don't want to walk all the way there. So I was wond–"

Poof!

Augh! Again? Really?! Catra immediately fell onto her knees, holding her stomach. They were in the kitchen. How? She didn't even see Glimmer grab her arm.

"I thought we agreed that you would give me a warning whenever you did that?!" Catra complained loudly, still waiting for the world to still before she dared to stand.

"Sorry," Glimmer replied sheepishly.

The room was still spinning. Catra closed her eyes for a moment.

"So…" Bow began, hesitantly, "Why did you need to go to the kitchen?"
Catra took a deep breath. Inhale. Exhale. The spinning finally stopped. She opened her eyes and saw that Glimmer was offering a hand. She took it and allowed Glimmer to pull her to her feet.

She then glanced at Bow and said, "Do you remember that purple tea you made back on Darla?"

"You mean the lavender tea?" Bow asked. Catra nodded. Bow was quiet for a moment and then his face lit up, realization dawned on him… Finally…

"Yeah! I'll make some real quick!" And he went to work opening the cabinets, taking out a teapot and finding the supplies to make it.

It took a few minutes but pretty soon, Bow had the tea made, poured a mug for both Adora and Glimmer and then Glimmer teleported them back to the hall where their bedrooms were. She offered to take Catra back to the room directly, but with Adora's current tired state, she didn't want to startle the blonde. Either Adora would be dead to the world asleep and wouldn't notice or it would spook her and even with the lavender tea, it could take her awhile to get her to relax enough to rest again. Plus the hallway was a nice middle point between both of their bedrooms.

So, with the hot, steaming cup of tea in her hand, she made her way back to the bedroom. When she opened the door, she was greeted by the sight of Adora barely laying on the bed. Her legs were off the mattress, her feet touching the floor. Melog was curled, tucked in by her side, purring very loudly. She noticed Adora stir a bit as she approached the bed. So, she wasn't completely asleep yet. Maybe just on the cusps of it. The lavender

tea would hopefully help her to fully fall asleep and more importantly stay asleep for a while.

Adora's eyes were half-closed. She was definitely fighting off sleep. She wasn't even sure if the blonde had heard her come back to the room. "Hey," She said softly, offering the mug, "drink this."

Adora didn't move. She didn't even acknowledge Catra's presence. Catra reached out and put a hand on Adora's shoulder, trying to let the blonde know that she was back. Adora's eyes opened more, she still didn't seem fully aware of her surroundings though. She carefully pulled Adora into a sitting position.

"Catra–" Adora began to say, the confusion clear in her voice.

"Just drink it," Catra replied softly and she offered a small smile. Adora looked up and met her gentle gaze. Adora took the mug and glanced at the drink in it. While she was distracted by the drink– Seriously, why was Adora staring at the tea so intensely, did she really think that after all this time, she would give her poison? Catra pushed that irritating thought away. While Adora was staring down the liquid in the mug, Catra reached back and carefully pulled the ponytail holder out of her hair.

After a moment, Adora sighed and then gulped the tea down. She offered the empty cup back to Catra, who took it without a word. She went to place it on the nightstand and in the couple of seconds that it took her to do that, Adora was out like a light.

Poof!

"Sparkles! What are you doing here?!" Catra demanded in a harsh whisper. Melog moved their head up from their spot beside Adora, lazily watching the exchange.

"Sorry!" Glimmer whispered back. Bow was standing next to her. She then continued on quietly, "I just wanted to check on Adora. I mean it's been a long…" Her words trailed off. Catra assumed that Sparkles was going to say 'week', 'it's been a long week', but

thought better of it. This exhaustion wasn't just from this week. It was from years of war; practically their whole lives, after all none of them had really lived in a time without war, not until this week at least.

Glimmer glanced at the bed, her gaze came to rest on a now slumbering Adora. Melog lowered their head and snuggled closer to the blonde, their purr echoing very loudly in the room.

"Finally," Glimmer sighed in relief.

"Finally," Catra scoffed and then added, "I can't believe she lasted a whole week. Everything with the Heart it was–" She stopped herself. The unwanted memories of that day were bubbling up and she didn't want to think about it, not now at least. She felt Glimmer and Bow watch her. She could feel the unasked questions on their lips, the worried gazes focused on her.

She took in a deep breath again. Inhale. Exhale. In the week since the war ended, Perfuma had shown her some exercises to help her relax, to help her calm her mind whenever the stressors of old would come for her. The only reason she even listened to the Princess of Flowers was because Scorpia kept asking and maybe she felt just a little bit guilty about how she treated Scorpia.

She didn't expect to actually learn anything from the Flower Princess. She also didn't expect to use the techniques Perfuma taught her and Scorpia. But she also didn't think that she would be standing in Bright Moon like she was now. She didn't conquer it but she also wasn't a prisoner. She stopped herself. She had other concerns. She could deal with the mental spiral of her place in the world later.

"Listen… At some point, we'll," and here she nodded towards Adora, trying to emphasize who 'we' were, "We'll explain everything that happened at the Heart… It's just that… Right now it's…" She felt a calm and comforting hand on her shoulder and

looked up to see that Bow was standing beside her now, smiling gently at her, concern in his eyes.

"We'll be ready when either of you want to talk about it. There's no reason to rush," he said in his usual, calm and soft way. Arrow Boy really did feel like the older brother she never had and never even knew that she wanted. She smiled back at him gratefully.

"Now," Bow turned her gaze to Glimmer. He looked a bit more stern now and he continued, "Since we've seen that Adora is in fact okay, let's get you to rest as well."

Glimmer huffed and replied in a whine, "Fine…" Bow took his hand off of Catra's shoulder and returned to Glimmer's side. He gave her a wave goodbye and– Poof! It was only Catra, Adora, and Melog again.

Catra glanced back at the bed. Adora still wasn't laying on it properly... Her back was on the bed, sure. But her legs weren't, it was like she was expecting that she would be needed at a moment's notice Of course she would believe that. And, maybe for a while, during the war that was true. But it wasn't war time anymore. It was the start of a new age. One that they would all have to adjust to.

Catra went over to the bed and leapt onto the mattress. The movement didn't wake Adora though, it didn't even cause her stir. Unlike Adora, Catra had mastered the art of not sinking into the soft mattress rather quickly. She could walk across this thing without losing a step, without getting buried in it. She carefully walked over to the blonde's hair and grabbed her by the shoulders to hoist her further up onto the bed. She moved her until her head was on one of the pillows and her legs and feet off the ground and fully on the mattress.

Melog immediately sat up, waiting patiently until Catra was satisfied that Adora was fully on the bed now. Catra then went back for the comforter and drew it back over Adora's sleeping form. Melog chose then to return to Adora's side and snuggle back

up, purring loudly as they did. Catra stifled her own yawn and glanced at the open windows. The sun was shining through the room and apparently now around the time that the sunbeam would hit their bed. It was warm. Inviting. Melog was on Adora's left, leaving the right side open and it was still in position of the sunbeam. She did a lot that day as well and while she had gotten more rest than Adora, she felt as though she wasn't completely recovered from that day, maybe a nap would help that.

Catra curled up by Adora's right. She didn't opt to go under the covers, after all, the sunbeam was providing plenty of heat and Adora always ran hot anyway. She felt Adora shift in her sleep, of course she did, she usually opted to sleep on her. An arm was now draped across her. Her own purr escaped, syncing up with Melog's almost immediately. She closed her eyes for just a moment.

Chapter End Notes

Any and all kudos and comments are deeply appreciated! Thank you so much for reading! Next chapter should be out soon!

Adora II

Chapter Summary

Adora tries to get up but the lullaby of purrs makes it hard...

Chapter Notes

Yoooo!!!! I am BACK with an update for this particular fic! Very sorry for the delay! I kept running into mental blocks but I HATE leaving work unfinished (if by chance you are or were reading my long fic... I make no promises on if or when that will get finished...)

Anyway, I was wanting to make this chapter longer but this is all I got for it. Catra's should be longer. Hopefully this chapter isn't too boring XD. But this fic is only fluff really. Fluff and concerned GF Catra so... Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Warm…

That was the first thing Adora noticed in her groggy state. She felt so… *warm*. It was a nice *warmth* though… At least she was pretty sure it was a nice warmth…

She didn't feel sick. The last time she remembered feeling this warm, was when she was sick. She couldn't remember the *how*. She caught a few random illnesses during her time with the Rebellion. And more than once either Bow or Glimmer, or even Queen Angella would demand her to return to her room and sleep off her fever. Being sick in the Rebellion was a lot different than being sick in the Horde. It took her some time but she *gradually* got used to it and begrudgingly learned to rest. She-Ra may heal her wounds and help her recover *quicker*, but the power of She-Ra didn't completely eliminate those issues.

No… She wasn't sick…

Actually, she felt… *good*...

…*No*... She realized… She felt great!

She already felt much better than she had in… She tried to think back. Her mind searched for the last time she remembered feeling *this* rested. The last time s felt this *safe*… This warm…

There was a low rumble nearby. Something felt as though it was vibrating against her chest. It was comforting. The dull rumble gently lulled her back to sleep's embrace… She fought against it. Her mind wanted to drift. She wouldn't let it. She had things she needed to do after all… She was *rested* now. That nap should have satisfied Glimmer. She *should* be okay to get up and return to her post-war duties now…

Rested...

She felt rested after her first few weeks in Bright Moon. She wouldn't say she felt *better* in Bright Moon. Falling asleep would often take her hours if she wasn't about to collapse from exhaustion. The Rebellion didn't overwork her like the Horde did but still, her missions and training could be a tad bit draining.

And even though Queen Angella didn't require her to put in the same amount of work, the same amount of effort, that Shadow Weaver had, Adora still couldn't shake that internal voice (one that sounded too much like Shadow Weaver's for her liking) that told her she wasn't good enough. That told her she wasn't strong enough. Or ready enough. And so, to prove to herself *and* the Rebellion (because she *knew* they had their doubts about her), she would often train until she collapsed. She would make sure every mission was completed *perfectly*. She couldn't afford to fail and so she *wouldn't*.

The rumbling against her chest grew louder. She felt *something* reach up and touch her chin. It lingered there for a few moments and then gradually slid off. Something was nestled against her,

she realized. It shifted, snuggling up closer. Out of instinct, she tightened her grip around it, bringing it closer to herself.

Was it… *purring*?

It was hard to sleep in the Horde. Although she grew up there, and the constant clatter of metal pipes and near continuous shouting down the hall didn't really keep her up, it was hard for her mind to relax. Sleep was often light. Even Catra (who was notorious for sleeping-in) would stir at even the *slightest* sense or note of danger. The clatter of pipes wasn't danger. Even the screaming between other cadets or soldiers in the halls wasn't a danger either…

Usually…

More often than naught that kind of yelling was just an argument, one that just got overheated. But it didn't include *them*. And as long as it didn't include *them* (even if she told Adora that she didn't *need* her worrying about her, Adora promised herself that she would always watch Catra's back…), then that kind of screaming wasn't danger.

In Bright Moon, things were *different*. There were guards. It was nearly silent (which actually made it *harder* for her to sleep until she finally grew used to the almost deadly quiet of the night). Just a few weeks before Shadow Weaver appeared and completely *destroyed* the fragile sense of safety she had begun to feel in Bright Moon, the palace felt like a *haven*. Even if she couldn't quite shake the fear that one misstep or one mistake could cost her everything and result in her being an outcast, banished from both the Rebellion and the Horde.

On the rare occasions that she camped out in the Whispering Woods with Glimmer and Bow, it was… *okay*… Glimmer hated it. She complained about the hardness of the ground. She lamented about the lack of protection against the sun so she could get a few more meager *hours* of sleep… Bow at least didn't seem to

mind sleeping outdoors. He seemed to be pretty used to *roughing it* as he called it whenever they camped out.

It didn't matter to Adora. Sleeping out in the woods didn't seem too different from sleeping in her bunk at the Horde. The ground was hard, but so was her mattress back hom– …back at the Horde.

She always woke up early in the Fright Zone. It was a habit she held onto even after she deserted and joined the Rebellion. Since she was already awake before the sun rose, it never occurred to her just how *bright* the mornings were. She never understood why Glimmer hated it.

It could be just a *tad* noisy in the Whispering Woods though, which was her only real issue with sleeping out in the woods. All throughout the night, she would listen, trying to distinguish which sounds were *dangerous* from the ones that weren't. Monsters roamed the woods afterall. And she needed to stay *just* awake enough and be coherent enough to fight and protect Glimmer and Bow *if* one of those monsters decided to attack.

She wanted to create a schedule. She even drew one up. Two of them could sleep while one stayed up and stood guard. It was the perfect plan! It was a procedure she grew up hearing all the time back hom- the *Horde*.

Glimmer scoffed at the idea when she brought it up, just two weeks after her defection, while they were traveling to Plumeria. According to Glimmer, the woods were *perfectly safe* and there was no reason none of them *should* have to stay awake, even if it was just for a few hours… taking turns so no one had the unfortunate responsibility of staying awake all night…

Bow was at least far nicer about it. He agreed with Adora, he explained to Glimmer the *wisdom* in it and for a bit the three of them tried it. Glimmer begrudgingly but still… A victory was a victory…

It lasted one night. Glimmer fell asleep turning her watch (no surprise there). Bow fell asleep too (a little surprising to Adora, but when she thought about it, Bow probably had an upbringing similar to Glimmer's. He might not have been a princess but he definitely didn't grow up like her.Or Catra. Or Lonnie. Or like anyone back hom– the Horde).

After that night, Adora decided that it was better to just follow Rule #42. There were hundreds of rules back the Horde but her instructors always, *always* emphasized Rule #42. Rule #42 was simple. Rule #42 was *important*.

Rule #42: sleep *where* you can, *when* you can.

She might lightly doze off while standing guard when they camp out. But she always woke up, alert and *ready* at the *slightest* sound in the woods. On the nights where she couldn't even doze off, she would find herself stealing a few measly seconds or even minutes (if she was lucky) of shut-eye whenever they would stop for a break midday for lunch or even just to rest their legs.

One time they had been whisked away for a meeting in the War Room as soon as they stepped foot back in Bright Moon. Her exhaustion and lack of sleep had been so bad after that trip that she actually fell asleep *during* the meeting, much to her embarrassment and the Queen's annoyance (she was still trying to earn Angella's trust back then. Over the years, Angella's feelings towards her softened and she even began to fuss over her much like she did Glimmer).

This morning though…

This morning she was feeling the most rested she had in her whole life.

She had been vaguely aware that something or rather *someone* was nestled in her arms, snoring lightly, and *purring* against her chest. She soon became aware that *someone* was cuddled behind her as well. An arm was draped over her, holding her close, while

another arm was snaked under her. It felt as though someone was hugging her. She hear faint, *familiar* light snoring just behind her head.

Adora cracked an eye open. She blinked, trying to clear her vision, still blurry from sleep. She shifted her head to glance at the bundle in her arms.

Melog.

They were nestled into her arms. They were stretched out but only for a moment. They curled back up into a ball. They were small right now, roughly the size of a normal house cat… But maybe just a *tad* bigger.

She lifted her head groggily and cast a quick glance at who was sleeping behind her. *Catra*. She wasn't surprised. She felt some *relief* actually. If Catra was *here* then maybe Glimmer didn't need them today. Maybe Etheria would be okay without them working today. If there was anything that absolutely *had* to be done today, then Catra would already be in one of the offices or something… At least *hopefully* she would be…

She was snuggled between Catra and Melog. The soft rumbling of vibrating of their purrs trying to lull her back to sleep. It was working. Her eyes fluttered closed again. The quiet rumbling beckoned her to return to her dreams once more; demanded that her mind drift back into the sweet solace of sleep…

The comforter was pulled over her… *When had that happened? Did she pull it over herself? Did Catra cover her sometime during the night?* It was cocooning her in even more *warmth*. Warmth she realized she didn't want to lose.

But she didn't fall asleep at night… Did she? She tried to think back. She fought the grogginess of her brain, trying to recall the moments that led her being shuffled back to room. She found that she barely remembered yesterday.

Flickers of the previous day (or maybe hour…? She wasn't sure how long she had slept) played in her mind. She remembered Catra being annoyed with her. She remembered talking to Glimmer… Or at least she *thought* she did. She could picture Glimmer in the hall. She could see Glimmer's mouth opening and closing, words being exchanged… But she felt *deaf* in her memory. The words didn't reach her ears. At least, she didn't remember them reaching her ears.

Melog stretched in their sleep again. A single paw reached out, their claws extended and hooked one of her hands. Adora winced a bit. Melog tried to bring it closer to themselves. Their purrs grew louder now with each passing moment.

It was tempting to fall back asleep. She felt *rested* though. Enough so that she *should* get up. Get up and tackle whatever the day had in store for her. Just because Horde Prime was gone, didn't mean that Etheria was completely safe yet. There was so much to do!

She tried to crack her eyes open again. She would force herself awake. She just had to ignore the siren call. She just had to ignore the soft rumble of purrs that continued to try and just beckon her back to sleep embrace of sleep.

Her eyelids were too heavy, she soon found as she was unable (much to her own annoyance) to pry them open.... Maybe if she moved… A low growl stopped her. Annoyed and maybe just a tad *exasperated* it sounded. She felt the pair of arms wrapped around her tighten.

"Go… ak… o… eep…" came Catra's sleepy voice in her ear. The purrs on both sides of her grew louder now, drowning out her thoughts. Adora stopped fighting. Sleep did sound nice.

Melog shifted in her arms again. She felt them stretching out a little more and then they curled back up into a tight ball. A claw was still in her hand, as if they were trying to make sure she

stayed in bed and fall back asleep. Their head rested on Adora’s arm.

It would be… *rude* to move now she decided. She felt Catra’s grip on her tighten even more. She felt breathing on her neck…

The purrs were *definitely* getting louder, she realized.

And louder…

Her thoughts drifted…

The call of more sleep was all too enticing…

Chapter End Notes

> One more chapter for this fic. Hopefully it'll be out sooner! We'll see! Any kudos and comments are very much appreciated, and they really do help motivate writers! I try to reply to all comments! Thank you for reading this chapter!

Catra II

Chapter Summary

> Catra tries to make Adora rest after their grueling experience at the Heart.

Chapter Notes

> Yay! I am now done with this fic! I might make a short sequel, I might not. I would *like* to write Catra and Adora's conversation about the need for taking care of themselves (IE: just freaking rest and don't overwork yourself), but that will be it's own separate fic *if* I get around to writing it. So I guess if you're interested in that, subscribe to my Post-Canon series or bookmark the series.
>
> This chapter is short, but it's done and it's only a fluff piece.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra felt Adora stir in her arms, moving as if she might just decide to get up rather than continue to stay in bed and get the sleep she so desperately needed.

Idiot…

She tightened her grip around Adora, trying to stop her from waking up *just* yet.

She assumed that at some point, Adora must have shifted in her sleep. She could have sworn that she fell asleep with Adora’s arm draped over her, now however, it seemed as if they switched. She was cuddling Adora. One arm over her and one arm snaked under. She was holding Adora close; her face was nestled in golden locks and the crook of Adora’s neck.

For a brief moment she wondered where Melog was. As soon as the question popped up in her head though, she felt the space-

cat's presence in her mind. Calm and groggy from sleep. Her ear twitched as their familiar purr rumbled nearby, on the other side of Adora. So apparently Melog was still doing their part in trying to make Adora rest too.

Good…. She felt a wave of appreciation for them. Their purrs grew louder then.

She wasn't sure how long she had been asleep. The sunbeam originally enticed her to sleep was long gone it seemed. She only meant to nap. And it was only until she was certain *Adora* had completely fallen asleep…

…But…

It certainly felt as though it had been a lot longer than a nap. Catra felt… *refreshed*. Rested even. She couldn't recall suffering of any of the familiar nightmares that plagued her. Her sleep had been *dreamless* in fact. For the first time in ages, her mind had shut itself up.

Finally… She mused to herself.

Her contentment was short-lived though, as she once again felt movement nearby. Her ear flickered in disappointment. She sighed but didn't open her eyes. She tightened her grip on Adora even more. She hugged Adora closer now; an effort to still the blonde who seemed too bound and determined to get up.

Just why couldn't Adora ever rest?

Catra's irritation grew. Her tail flicked above for a moment, which was *slightly* harder to do under the sheets and comforter that trapped her on the bed (when those start to feel so heavy?) and then it thumped against the mattress, the sound muted by the covers.

This whole "nap" started because she knew that Adora hadn't taken the time to rest after the Heart; not properly at least. However long they had slept, Catra was sure it still wasn't *long*

enough… She knew Adora needed more rest! She also knew that Adora wouldn't get that rest; not unless someone made her. So, Catra decided that she would. She spent years trying to keep the dumb blonde from harming herself while they were cadets in the Horde. What difference would it make if she spent the rest of her life doing that?

That brought forth more thoughts. Ideas that she hadn't ever given much consideration before. Because there was no point, not because they weren't what she actually wanted in life. They spent so long as enemies. So long fighting, trying to one-up another… trying to *kill* each other…

Catra fought back the shiver that threatened to overcome her then. She knew Adora was in that mental fog somewhere between being awake and asleep. If she was careful, she could probably cox Adora into sleeping for a few more hours. She almost fell asleep just standing up earlier! If she shuddered or gave any indication that she was going through something, even if it was just a brief, fleeting bad memory, it would wake Adora up completely. And she didn't want that now. She wanted Adora to rest! To sleep! Even if just for a *few* more minutes (although *hours* or even *days* are what she truly preferred).

Adora stirred again. The idiot was *really* fighting sleep now. And Catra *really* needed her to rest. If she let Adora go on like she had been after the Heart, who knows how long the idiot would last? Even without the Horde, without Prime, or even a threat, Adora would find *some way* to overwork herself. She always did.

Prime was gone.

The Horde… Gone.

There was nothing left for her to fight. Nothing left for her to *protect* them from.

Shadow Weaver's words, spoken *only* to Adora, but overheard by an unseen Catra, echoed her in mind then. Words that stirred up

anger and bitterness. Stupid instruction from mentor to student:

…The world needs you as She-Ra right now, not Adora…

Stupid witch! Without thinking, she growled a little.

Stupid Shadow Weaver!

The world was safe now. The *world* didn't *need* She-Ra now! But Catra needed Adora. She snuggled closer. Her tail snaked through the much too soft and heavy covers that were draped over them and curled around one of Adora's ankles.

Adora was still stirring a little. It was really frustrating Catra now.

"'Dor…" she murmured sleepily in the blonde's ear. She tightened her embrace around Adora.

"...Go back to sleep…" Catra murmured into Adora's ear. She was surprised at how *tired* and rough her own voice sounded. She felt Adora finally begin to still.

Good. Her ears flickered as she heard the faint ruffle of the sheets as Melog stretched for a moment. The sheets ruffled slightly again, and in her mind, she could see Melog curl back up into a ball.

They had a single claw in Adora's hand apparently, an effort on their part to keep Adora from moving. For good measure, they rested their head on one of Adora's arms. Catra, with her eyes still shut as she tried to will herself back to the sweet, sweet embrace of sleep.

She felt Adora relax in her. A light snore came soon after.

Idiot… She thought fondly.

She wasn't sure if it was day or night. She knew she *wanted* more sleep. She also knew she would need to have a nice, long talk

with Adora when they both woke up (after ensuring the blonde had gotten *enough* rest of course!). Catra let her mind drift.

Talks.

Bright Moon.

Duty.

Etheria.

It could all wait. The responsibilities of She-Ra could wait. She-Ra had done her part. Etheria was safe. Now, the world…

...No…

Catra needed *Adora*. She didn't need She-Ra. Just Adora.

Chapter End Notes

Any kudos and comments are appreciated! Thank you so much for reading this!

End Notes

Any kudos and comments are appreciated! Thank you for reading this story! If you like this, I have some other She-Ra fics as well. I also have some Arcane fics too! And a couple of Legend of Zelda ones... Anyway! Next chapter should be up soon!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!